Is Your LAMP Server Secure?

It's no secret that the Internet is stuffed with various bots that try to get into the 'body' of your site, or simply put — to hack it. Therefore, after installing a LAMP server, you need to configure it to protect your site from such attempts.

LAMP is a very popular combination of free and open source software and is used today to run millions of websites. Although many choose a more efficient LAMP stack based on nginx instead of Apache, there are still a significant number of users who choose LAMP for their projects. In fact, more than 30 per cent of active sites today are running on top of LAMP. The stack is considered reliable and is very suitable for working, with high performance and availability of Web applications. In this article, we are going to show you how to protect LAMP.

What is LAMP?

LAMP is a freely distributed and virtually free software suite. Four popular technologies are included in this bundle: Linux - the operating system; Apache - the Web server; MySQL- the database management system; and PHP - the programming language used to create Web resources.

The LAMP combination is:

- Linux server OS for performing the necessary tasks;
- Apache Web server, for which many additional modules have been created that solve the problem of working together with the Web server and scripts written in a variety of programming languages;
- MySQL DBMS that demonstrates excellent SQL query execution speed, and is ideal for small and medium-sized projects. MySQL runs on UNIX and Windows and is particularly easy to use;
- Server-side dynamic scripting language, which is generally PHP (but can also be Python or Perl).

A significant advantage of this build is that it is great for fast deployment of the application because of the simple configuration, but still gives functionality in terms of scalability and isolation of components.

Among the disadvantages of such an assembly, the following should be highlighted: The application and the database use the same server resources (CPU, memory, I/O, etc), which gives poor performance and makes it difficult to determine the source (application or database) of this problem. There is also interference in the implementation of horizontal scaling.